

Conference: Game Theory, Political Economy & Development

Day 1: Theory (December 11, 2025)

Time	Session	Speakers
9:00 AM – 9:30 AM	Registration	
9:30 AM – 9:40 AM	Opening Remarks	<i>Rida Laraki, Full Professor at Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P), Director of the Moroccan Center for Game Theory.</i> <i>Leonard Wantchekon, James Madison Professor of Political Economy, Princeton University; Founder & President, African School of Economics.</i>
9:40 AM – 10:40 AM	Keynote Speech	<i>“The Micro-foundations of Authoritarianism.” Kaushik Basu, Professor of Economics & Carl Marks Professor of International Studies, Department of Economics, Cornell University.</i>
10:40 AM – 11:00 AM	Coffee Break	
11:00 AM – 12:30 PM	Session 1A	<i>Session Chair: Olga Gorelkina, Assistant Professor in Economics, Africa Business School, UM6P.</i> <i>Speakers:</i> 1. <i>“Efficient Provision of Multiple Public Goods through Private Contributions: An Institutional Edits Approach.” (joint work with Salil Sharma and Leonard Wantchekon), Mark Voorneveld, Associate Professor of Economics, Stockholm School of Economics.</i> 2. <i>“The Political Economy of Morality Policies: Collective Choice and Denial.” Renee Bowen, Dean’s Professor of International Business & Global Affairs, Georgetown University.</i> 3. <i>“Rational Deterrence in Internal Armed Conflicts.” Gaétan Nandong, Assistant Professor of Politics, Department of Politics, New York University.</i>
12:30 PM – 2:00 PM	Lunch	
2:00 PM – 3:30 PM	Session 1B	<i>Session Chair: Olga Gorelkina, Assistant Professor in Economics, Africa Business School, UM6P.</i> <i>Speakers:</i> 1. <i>“Liquid Democracy and Information Aggregation.” Amrita Dhillon, Professor of Economics, King’s College London.</i>

2. “Strategic Disclosure in Networks.” Francesco Squintani, Professor of Economics; Director, Quantitative and Analytical Political Economy Centre (QAPEC), University of Warwick.
3. “Threats to Commitment: Bank Regulation and Governance under Renegotiation Concerns.” Karna Basu, Associate Professor of Economics, Hunter College and The Graduate Center, City University of New York (CUNY).

3:30 PM – Coffee

4:00 PM Break

4:00 PM – **Session 1C** Session Chair: Alexey Kushnir, Associate Professor of Economics, Moroccan Center
5:30 PM for Game Theory, UM6P.

Speakers:

1. “Coordinating Development Under Political Risk.” (co-authored with Harshal Zalke), Mehdi Shadmehr, Associate Professor of Public Policy, Department of Public Policy, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.
2. “Majority Judgment in Paris Participatory Budgeting: Evidence from the 2022–2023.” Yukio Koriyama, Full Professor of Economics (Professeur de la classe exceptionnelle), École Polytechnique.
3. “Why Majority Judgement is a Good Voting Method.” Rida Laraki, Full Professor at Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P), Director of the Moroccan Center for Game Theory.

Day 2: Empirics (December 12, 2025)

Time	Session	Speakers
9:00 AM – 10:30 AM	Session 2A	Session Chair: Bilal Islah, Assistant Professor of Business Economics, Africa Business School, Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P). Speakers: 1. “Bureaucratic Deliberation and Performance: Evidence from a Field Experiment in Benin.” Shan Aman-Rana, Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Virginia. 2. “Audits and Bureaucratic Corruption: Evidence from Brazilian Municipalities.” (with Renaud Bourlès, Galileu Kim, and Julieta Peveri), Romain Ferrali, Assistant Professor of Economics, Aix-Marseille School of Economics. 3. “Multidimensional Learning in Committee Deliberations.” Nathan Canen, Associate Professor of Economics, University of Warwick.

10:30 AM – Coffee
11:00 AM Break

11:00 AM – **Session** *Session Chair: Bilal Islah, Assistant Professor of Business Economics,*
12:30 PM **2B** *Africa Business School, Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P).*

1. “Refugee Return and Conflict: Evidence from a Natural Experiment.” Christopher Blair, Assistant Professor of Politics, Princeton University.
2. “Rolling Back Subsidies, Rolling in the Unrest? Social Policy Reform and Civil Unrest in Iran.” Amir Abdul Reda, Assistant Professor in Computational Political Science, Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P) and Moritz Schmoll, Assistant Professor in Political Science, Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P).
3. “Moral Violence: At the Heart of Congo’s Major Militia.” Raúl Sánchez de la Sierra, Associate Professor, Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago.

12:30 PM – Lunch
2:00 PM

2:00 PM – 3:30 **Session** *Amrita Dhillon, Professor of Economics, King’s College London.*
PM **2C**

Speakers:

1. “En Route: The French Colonial Army, Emigration, and Development in Morocco.” Awa Ambra Seck, Assistant Professor, Harvard Business School.
2. “Les Agoudas: Pre-colonial Business Networks and Intergenerational Mobility of Liberated Returnees.” (co-authored with Leonard Wantchekon), Guilherme Lambais, Assistant Professor of Economics, Lusiada University of Lisbon.
3. “Culture, Institutions, and Gold Mining Booms: Theory and Evidence from Burkina Faso.” Nouhoum Touré, Assistant Professor (MCF), Centre d’Economie de la Sorbonne, Sorbonne University.

3:30 PM – 4:00 Coffee
PM Break

4:00 PM – 5:30 PM **Session 2D** *Amrita Dhillon, Professor of Economics, King's College London.*

Speakers:

1. *"Public Policy in the Presence of Social Norms."* Rohini Somanathan, Professor of Economics, Delhi School of Economics (DSE), University of Delhi.
2. *"When Democracy Refuses to Die: Evaluating a Training Program for New Politicians."* (joint with Ernesto Dal Bó, Frederico Finan, and Pedro Pessoa), Claudio Ferraz, Professor of Economics, University of British Columbia (UBC).
3. *"Mining and the Transformation of Conflict and Social Unrest in Africa."* Ahmed Tritah, Professor of Economics, Université of Poitiers; Chaire EIEA, UM6P.

7:30 PM – 9:30 PM **Formal Conference Dinner**

Day 3: Policy & Development (December 13, 2025)

Time	Session/Panel	Speakers
9:00 AM – 10:30 AM	Panel 3A: Institutions and Development	1. <i>Paul Seabright, Professor of Economics, Toulouse School of Economics (TSE).</i> 2. <i>Youssef Farhat, Deputy Budget Director, Ministry of Economy & Finance, Kingdom of Morocco.</i>
10:30 AM - 11:00 AM	Coffee Break	
11:00 AM – 12:30 PM	Panel 3B: Service Delivery & Local Governance	1. <i>Stuti Khemani, Senior Economist, Development Research Group, The World Bank.</i> 2. <i>Sania Nishtar, CEO, Gavi, The Vaccine Alliance; Former Senator, Pakistan.</i> <i>Moderated by: Anas Lahlou, Operations Director of the Chair, Industrial Economy & the Emergence of Africa, UM6P.</i>
12:30 PM – 2:00 PM	Lunch	

2:00 PM – 3:30
PM

**Session 3C:
Finance and
Development**

1. “Exporters and Labor Market Outcomes: Evidence from Egypt Using Census Data.” Ayhab Saad, Assistant Professor of Political Science, Doha Institute for Graduate Studies.
2. “Short-term Finance, Long-term Effects.” (with Omar Chafik, Min Fang, and Wendi Tang), Kenza Benhima, Full Professor of Economics, University of Lausanne (HEC Lausanne).
3. “Financial System and Institutional Dynamics in Morocco.” Mohamed Wail Aaminou, Affiliate Professor at the Sustainable Business Economic Center (SBEC), UM6P.

Moderated by: Ahmed Tritah, Professor of Economics, University of Poitiers; Chaire EIEA, UM6P.

3:30 PM - 4:30
PM

**Poster
Session: Game
Theory,
Political
Economy &
Development**

1. Julio Solis Arce, PhD Candidate, Harvard University.
2. Yabo Vidogbena, Postdoctoral Fellow, University of Pennsylvania.
3. Rethis Togbedji Gansey, PhD Candidate, Princeton University.
4. Joshua Limpert, PhD Candidate, Princeton University.
5. Elena Istomina, Postdoctoral Scholar, UM6P & Princeton University.

4:30 PM – 5:30
PM

**Keynote
Speech:
Future
Directions in
Political
Economy
Research**

Leonard Wantchekon, James Madison Professor of Political Economy, Princeton University; Founder & President, African School of Economics.

5:30 PM – 5:50
PM

**Closing
Remarks**

Rida Laraki, Full Professor at Université Mohammed VI Polytechnique (UM6P), Director of the Moroccan Center for Game Theory.